

LCM Examinations

Piano Handbook

Grade 1, Recital Grade 1 and Level 1 Leisure Play

Introduction

This publication is part of a progressive series of handbooks, primarily intended for candidates considering taking London College of Music examinations in Piano. However, given each handbook's wide content of musical repertoire and associated educational material, the series provides a solid foundation of musical education for any piano student, of any age, whether they are intending to take an exam or not.

Examination candidates must also refer to the current LCM syllabus and repertoire list.

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Technical Work

Candidates should prepare EITHER scales, broken chords and arpeggios OR the study.

To be played *legato* and from memory.

Scales

Minimum speed: ♩ = 69

C, G, D and F major with separate hands (two octaves).

C Major

R.H. 
L.H. 

The C major scale is shown for both right and left hands, spanning two octaves. The right hand starts on middle C (C4) and the left hand starts on C2. Fingering is indicated by numbers 1-5 above or below the notes.

G Major

R.H. 
L.H. 

The G major scale (one sharp: F#) is shown for both right and left hands, spanning two octaves. The right hand starts on G4 and the left hand starts on G2. Fingering is indicated by numbers 1-5 above or below the notes.

D Major

2

R.H.

L.H.

C, G and D major scales hands together in similar motion (one octave).

C Major

G Major

D Major

A musical score for the song 'The Rose Tree'. It features a treble and bass staff with a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#). The melody is written in the treble staff, and the bass line is in the bass staff. The melody consists of a series of eighth and quarter notes, with fingerings indicated by numbers 1 through 5. The bass line provides a simple accompaniment with eighth and quarter notes, also with fingerings. The score ends with a double bar line.

A and D minor scales (harmonic or melodic, at the candidate's choice) with separate hands (two octaves).

A Harmonic Minor

R.H. 

L.H. 

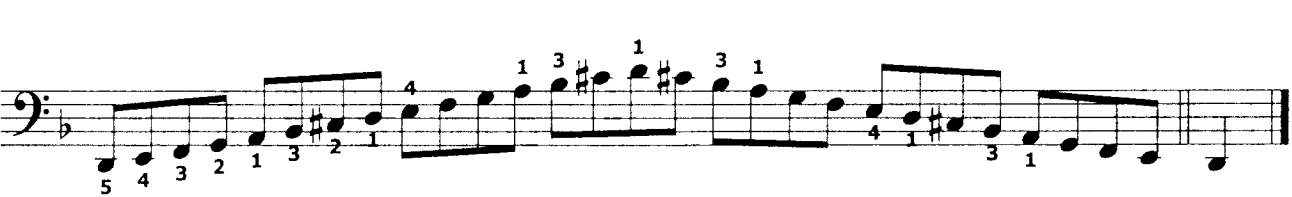
OR:
A Melodic Minor

R.H. 

L.H. 

D Harmonic Minor

R.H. 

L.H. 

OR:
D Melodic Minor

R.H. 

L.H. 

C major in contrary motion, hands together, beginning and ending on the same key-note (one octave).

Broken Chords

C and G major and A minor, with separate hands.

Minimum speed: ♩ = 100

C Major

G Major

A Minor

Arpeggios

C and F major and D minor, in root position, with separate hands (one octave).

Minimum speed: ♩ = 100

C Major

R.H. 

L.H. 

F Major

R.H. 

L.H. 

D Minor

R.H. 

L.H. 

Study

Inside Out

Tony Pegler

Allegro ♩ = 126

Measures 1-4 of the piece. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 2/4. The tempo is Allegro with a quarter note equal to 126 beats per minute. The dynamic is *mf* (mezzo-forte). The notation includes fingerings: measure 1 has a triplet of eighth notes in the treble (fingerings 3, 2, 1) and a single eighth note in the bass (fingering 5); measure 2 has eighth notes in both staves (fingerings 2, 1 in treble, 4, 3 in bass); measure 3 has a slur over a quarter note and an eighth note in the treble (fingerings 4, 2) and a quarter note in the bass (fingering 4); measure 4 has a quarter note in the treble (fingering 2) and a quarter note in the bass (fingering 4).

Measures 5-8 of the piece. Measure 5 has a triplet of eighth notes in the treble (fingerings 3, 2, 1) and a quarter note in the bass (fingering 5). Measure 6 has eighth notes in both staves (fingerings 2, 1 in treble, 4, 3 in bass). Measure 7 has a quarter note in the treble (fingering 1) and a quarter note in the bass (fingerings 1, 2, 1). Measure 8 has a quarter note in the treble (fingering 4) and a quarter note in the bass (fingering 4).

Measures 9-12 of the piece. Measure 9 has a quarter note in the treble (fingering 1) and a quarter note in the bass (fingering 2). Measure 10 has a half note in the treble (fingering 3) and a half note in the bass (fingering 1). Measure 11 has a quarter note in the treble (fingering 5) and a quarter note in the bass (fingerings 1, 2, 1). Measure 12 has a quarter note in the treble (fingering 3) and a quarter note in the bass (fingering 3).

Measures 13-16 of the piece. Measure 13 has a triplet of eighth notes in the treble (fingerings 3, 2, 1) and a quarter note in the bass (fingering 1). Measure 14 has a quarter note in the treble (fingering 4) and a quarter note in the bass (fingering 4). Measure 15 has a half note in the treble (fingering 5) and a half note in the bass (fingering 5). Measure 16 has a quarter note in the treble (fingering 1) and a quarter note in the bass (fingering 5).

17

p

21

25

mf *p* *mf* *p*

29

mf *rall.* *f*

List A

Trumpet Tune

You need to be quite sure of what a trumpet sounds like to play this piece! The bright, clear projection of this brass instrument should 'shine' through the R.H. playing.

Much of this piece is like a fanfare heralding an important occasion – the notes in the opening theme are based on the C major chord. There are lots of repeated notes in the R.H. so perform these with a confident, bouncy *staccato*. This is an excellent piece for developing a loose wrist *staccato*, particularly as it is really only needed when single notes are repeated (or pairs of notes in the middle section) so you don't have to worry about moving your hand – just perfecting your *staccato* technique! However, don't let your fingers lose their firmness, otherwise the tone will not be bold enough and this will no longer sound like a fanfare.

William Duncombe
(c1736 - 1818)

Allegro ♩ = 120

The musical score for 'Trumpet Tune' is presented in three systems, each with a grand staff (treble and bass clef). The key signature is one flat (B-flat), and the time signature is 3/4. The tempo is marked 'Allegro' with a quarter note equal to 120 beats per minute. The dynamics range from forte (f) to piano (p). The score includes various musical notations such as staccato marks, slurs, and fingerings. The first system covers measures 1-4, the second system covers measures 5-8, and the third system covers measures 9-12. The piece concludes with a final cadence in the right hand.

13

mp

mf

(3)
(1)
4
2

5

(3)
(1)
4
2

1 2 1 2

17

f

1 1 1 4 3

3 5

2

21

4 3 4 5 1 3 1

1 4 2 3 2

German Dance

This piece is really a minuet in disguise, so think about the lilting 3/4 metre and have a look at some of the things mentioned in the notes to Leopold Mozart's 'Minuet in D'.

Try to observe the slur details in the R.H. – this might feel a little tricky in the first section because the L.H. has to maintain a flowing *legato* bass line underneath. However, in the second section, both hands are in complete agreement.

♩ = 126

Joseph Haydn
(1732 - 1809)

Repeats are not required for examination purposes.

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Minuet in D

This was written for the composer's daughter, Nannerl – sister of the much more famous Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart.

The piece is in the style of a graceful minuet – a dance very popular in the eighteenth century. One of the most important things in trying to convey the style of a minuet is to feel the sense of the triple metre flow – it's just like when you are preparing for the aural tests for this grade, if you clap in time with a 3/4 piece you have to stress the first beat of the bar; you should feel much of the same thing when you are performing a minuet. The last beat of the bar is often detached and great care should be taken to play it gently.

Leopold Mozart
(1719 - 1787)

♩ = 112

The musical score for 'Minuet in D' by Leopold Mozart is presented in four systems. The key signature is D major (two sharps) and the time signature is 3/4. The tempo is marked with a quarter note equal to 112 beats per minute. The piece is written for piano, with a treble and bass staff joined by a brace. The first system (measures 1-4) starts with a mezzo-forte (mf) dynamic. The second system (measures 5-8) features a forte (f) dynamic. The third system (measures 9-12) begins with a piano (p) dynamic and ends with a mezzo-forte (mf) dynamic. The fourth system (measures 13-15) returns to a forte (f) dynamic. The score includes various musical notations such as slurs, ties, and fingerings (e.g., 1, 2, 4, 3, 4, 3, 2, 1, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1, 5). The final measure of the fourth system is a repeat sign.

Repeats are not required for examination purposes.

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List B

Sonatina in C, Op.36 No.3

This beautiful slow movement is taken from a sonatina by a well-known classical composer who also wrote many studies for the piano. A stylish performance of this piece will project a good awareness of classical two and four bar phrasing, a good *legato* touch and singing tone in the right hand and also a sensitive response to the rise and fall of the melody. Non-harmonic notes (quavers and semiquavers) should not be over-emphasised.

Un poco Adagio ♩ = 66

Muzio Clementi
(1752 - 1832)

The musical score for Sonatina in C, Op.36 No.3 by Muzio Clementi is presented in four systems. Each system consists of a treble and bass staff. The key signature is one sharp (F#), and the time signature is 3/4. The tempo is marked 'Un poco Adagio' with a quarter note equal to 66 beats per minute. The score includes various musical notations such as slurs, fingerings, and dynamic markings like *p dolce*, *cresc.*, *dim.*, *pp*, and *p*. The piece concludes with a repeat sign at the end of the fourth system.

Repeats are not required for examination purposes.

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Scarborough Fair

This is an arrangement of a very beautiful and well-known English tune; Scarborough is a famous seaside resort on the east coast. You will need to decide on the mood of this piece so that you can play with the right expression.

The piece is in 3/4 time, so it needs to lilt gently. It is based on a song and maybe your teacher will know the words. Not quite all of the notes of the song are found in this piece – this is because it is an 'arrangement' for piano and doesn't have to be sung. Some of the R.H. melody notes are hinted at in the L.H. – see if you can pick these out. However, most of the time the L.H. is there to accompany the melody line, so never let it become too loud. The notes of bars 3 and 4 contain an important dotted rhythm and need careful co-ordination of the hands – you will hear how the words of the title 'Scarborough Fair' fit exactly to the rhythm of these two bars.

Allegretto ♩ = 126

Trad., arr. Peter Wild

The musical score for 'Scarborough Fair' is presented in four systems. Each system consists of a grand staff with a treble and bass clef. The key signature has one sharp (F#), and the time signature is 3/4. The tempo is marked 'Allegretto' with a quarter note equal to 126 beats per minute. The dynamics range from mezzo-forte (mf) to piano (p). The score includes various musical notations such as slurs, ties, and fingerings to guide the performer. The piece ends with a final cadence in the fourth system.

Song Without Words

Spindler was a German composer of the nineteenth century. He wrote many short pieces for students in the first stages of learning to play the piano.

As in 'Scarborough Fair', the piece flows in a triple metre but this time it is 3/8 (three quaver beats in a bar). The melody is always in the R.H. but it contains quite a few longer notes – if it is too slow it will be difficult to hear the flow of the melody and the piece will start to drag. It is also important that the L.H. does not become too loud.

Moderato ♩. = 60

Fritz Spindler
(1817 - 1905)

The musical score is written for piano in 3/8 time. It consists of four systems of staves, each with a treble and bass clef. The right hand (RH) plays the melody, and the left hand (LH) provides a harmonic accompaniment. The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, slurs, and fingerings. Dynamics include *p cantabile*, *poco a poco cresc.*, and *mf*. The piece is marked 'Moderato' with a tempo of 60 beats per minute.

Measures 1-6: RH starts with a half note (1), followed by quarter notes (3, 5). LH has a continuous eighth-note accompaniment. Dynamics: *p cantabile*. Fingerings: 5 (legato) in LH.

Measures 7-11: RH continues with half notes (1, 2, 3). LH continues with eighth-note accompaniment. Dynamics: *poco a poco cresc.*

Measures 12-16: RH continues with half notes (3, 4, 3). LH continues with eighth-note accompaniment.

Measures 17-20: RH continues with half notes (2, 5, 3). LH continues with eighth-note accompaniment. Dynamics: *mf*. Fingerings: 4, 3, 1 (5, 4, 2) in LH.

poco rall.

Repeats are not required for examination purposes.

List C

Cowboy Song

Now we travel to the Wild West. This piece is written with a clear sense of the American folk style. The lively syncopated rhythm used in bars 1-3 is used a lot – can you spot each time it comes up?

The L.H. only plays chords, but many of them are three-note chords (often called 'triads'). You will need to be careful when working out the notes on the third line, but once you have done this you will soon see how they make a pattern. Use each of the rests to allow your hand to move to the next chord.

Can you see the treble clef at the end of bar 9? This is to warn you that the L.H. must play up in the treble clef. Bars 9-12 are exactly the same as bars 5-8, but here both hands are an octave higher.

The repeat of the first four bars should be played so that we can hear the change in dynamics.

Moderato ♩ = 120

Stephen Baron

The musical score for 'Cowboy Song' is presented in three systems, each with a piano (L.H.) and treble (R.H.) staff. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The tempo is Moderato, with a quarter note equal to 120 beats per minute.

System 1 (Bars 1-4): The piano part plays chords in the bass clef, while the treble part plays a syncopated melody. Dynamics include *f* (2nd time *p*). Fingerings are indicated for the treble part.

System 2 (Bars 5-8): The piano part continues with chords. The treble part features more complex melodic lines with triplets and slurs. Dynamics include *f*.

System 3 (Bars 9-12): This system is a repeat of the first four bars but transposed an octave higher. The piano part now uses a treble clef. Dynamics include *p*.

Square-O

You will have to learn how to 'swing' the rhythm before you can play this piece. Look at the composer's direction at the top of the page – the quavers are not intended to be played in a 'straight' fashion, they are always swung. Your teacher will help you to understand this, perhaps by clapping and then by playing very simple patterns in this rhythm.

You will probably see straight away that the R.H. is more or less the same on each line. Initially, the R.H. is solo so that we can get to know the tune. Notice the very important slurring detail with gives character to the melody, but do take care not to accent or 'bump' the second note of each paired slur. The L.H. begins at bar 5, and is different on each line. Line 3 has both hands playing the same rhythm and articulation (and the melody is the same in both hands, except the L.H. plays six notes lower). On the last line the L.H. accompanies the melody with attractive *staccato* chords and finishes with some unexpected flattened notes to give a lovely twist at the end.

No cutting corners ♩ = c.160 (♩♩ = ♩♩)

Elissa Milne

In the Hall of the Mountain Bear

This will sound familiar to many of you – it is based on a very well-known tune by Grieg, a famous composer of the nineteenth century. Pam Wedgwood borrowed the tune and created her own piece from it (which is why she writes 'with apologies to Mr Grieg' in the top right corner of the music!). The original title was 'In the Hall of the Mountain King'. What sort of bear do you think he is? Look at all the accents in bars 9 and 10 and again on the fifth line; these certainly make him sound rather bad-tempered, don't you think?

Don't play the piece too quickly but do make the *staccato* very clear, and of course, look carefully at the dynamic changes.

With a grizzly feeling – not fast ♩ = 112

Pam Wedgwood (with apologies to Mr Grieg)

The musical score is written for piano in 4/4 time, key of D major. It consists of 13 measures. The tempo is marked as 112 beats per minute. The score includes dynamic markings (p, f, mp, mf), articulation (accents, staccato), and fingering (1, 2, 4, 5). The piece is based on a well-known tune by Grieg.

17

3

ff

p

3

1

21

4

25

5

f

ff

1

Viva Voce

Candidates will be engaged in a short discussion which enables the examiner to assess their understanding of musical fundamentals, and their responses to the pieces played.

Here are some examples of the type of questions which may be asked at Grade 1. It should be stressed that these are only examples; the list is by no means exhaustive, and the candidate should not simply learn these answers by rote.

1. *Examiner:* Which of the pieces that you played today is your favourite, and why?
Candidate: My favourite is 'Trumpet Tune', because it is fun and sounds like a fanfare.
2. *Examiner:* What is the name for these five lines in the music? [*Examiner points to the five lines*]
Candidate: The staff (or stave).
3. *Examiner:* What is the pitch of this note? [*Examiner points to a minim G in 'Scarborough Fair'*]
Candidate: G.
4. *Examiner:* What is the name of its note value?
Candidate: A minim.
5. *Examiner:* How many beats is a minim worth?
Candidate: 2 beats.
6. *Examiner:* What is this and what does it mean? [*Examiner points to the time signature*]
Candidate: It is the time signature. $\frac{4}{4}$ means there are four crotchet beats in each bar.
7. *Examiner:* What does this symbol mean? [*Examiner points to *f* on the score*]
Candidate: It stands for *forte*, which means that the music should be played loudly.
8. *Examiner:* What is this? [*Examiner points to a treble clef*]
Candidate: It is a treble clef (or G clef).

Sight Reading

Following are examples of the style and standard of LCM Grade 1 sight reading tests:

At an even, steady speed ♩ = 80

1

Exercise 1, measures 1-4. Treble clef, 4/4 time, *mf*. The melody consists of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line has whole rests.

Exercise 1, measures 5-8. Treble clef, 4/4 time, *f*. The melody consists of whole notes: C4, D4, E4, F4. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, D3, E3, F3, G3, A3, B3, C4.

At an even, steady speed ♩ = 72

2

Exercise 2, measures 1-4. Treble clef, 3/4 time, *f*. The melody consists of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line has whole rests.

Exercise 2, measures 5-8. Treble clef, 3/4 time, *f*. The melody consists of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line has whole rests.

Slow and evenly ♩ = 88

3

Exercise 3, measures 1-4. Treble clef, 2/4 time, *mp*. The melody consists of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line has whole rests.

Exercise 3, measures 5-8. Treble clef, 2/4 time, *mf*. The melody consists of quarter notes: C4, D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, C5. The bass line consists of quarter notes: C3, D3, E3, F3, G3, A3, B3, C4.

Aural Tests

Grade candidates will be asked to complete some aural tests, designed to assess the candidate's listening ability and musicianship. The following are examples of LCM Grade 1 aural tests:

Rhythm

Test 1a Identify the time signature as '2' or '3' time.

[2 marks]

Allegretto

i)

mf

This musical example is in 2/4 time, marked Allegretto. The treble clef part begins with a half note chord (F#4, A4) followed by a series of eighth and quarter notes. The bass clef part consists of a steady eighth-note accompaniment.

Moderato

ii)

mf

This musical example is in 2/4 time, marked Moderato. The treble clef part features a melody of eighth and quarter notes. The bass clef part provides a steady eighth-note accompaniment.

Moderato

iii)

f

This musical example is in 2/4 time, marked Moderato. The treble clef part has a melody of eighth and quarter notes. The bass clef part features a steady eighth-note accompaniment.

Allegretto

iv)

mf

This musical example is in 2/4 time, marked Allegretto. The treble clef part begins with a half note chord (F#4, A4) followed by a series of eighth and quarter notes. The bass clef part consists of a steady eighth-note accompaniment.

Moderato

v)

f

This musical example is in 2/4 time, marked Moderato. The treble clef part features a melody of eighth and quarter notes. The bass clef part provides a steady eighth-note accompaniment.

Test 1b Clap or tap on each pulse beat, in time, in 2 or 3 time, accenting the first beat of each bar, as the examiner plays the passage again. [2 marks]

NB. Candidates may elect to respond to tests 1(a) and 1(b) in reverse order. In this case, the examiner should be informed in advance of the tests being administered.

Pitch

Test 2a Identify as 'first' or 'second' which of two notes played consecutively is EITHER the higher OR the lower (at the examiner's discretion). [1 mark]

Test 2a consists of ten pairs of notes, labeled i to x, played consecutively on a single staff. The notes are as follows:

- i: C4 (quarter), D4 (quarter)
- ii: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter)
- iii: E4 (quarter), F4 (quarter)
- iv: F4 (quarter), G4 (quarter)
- v: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter)
- vi: A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter)
- vii: B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter)
- viii: C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter)
- ix: B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter)
- x: A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter)

Test 2b Sing back one of the two notes as requested. The examiner will play the two notes again and say: "Sing the 1st/2nd note I played" OR "Sing the higher/lower of the two notes I played". [1 mark]

Test 2c Sing clearly the missing final tonic of a short melody in a major key. The key chord will be sounded. [2 marks]

Test 2c consists of four short melodies, labeled i to iv, each in a different major key. The key chord is sounded at the beginning of each melody. The melodies are as follows:

- i) Key of C major (C4-E4-G4). Melody: C4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter).
- ii) Key of F major (F4-A4-C5). Melody: F4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), F4 (quarter).
- iii) Key of D major (D4-F#4-A4). Melody: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), D5 (quarter).
- iv) Key of B major (B4-D#4-F#4). Melody: B4 (quarter), C#4 (quarter), D#4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G#4 (quarter), A#4 (quarter), B5 (quarter).